HACK876 × ISLAND GRILL

PRIVATE PARTNERSHIP PROPOSAL

Eat good. Live good. Build something.

Island Grill has always reached beyond the restaurant walls. Hack876 is a long day of building for young Jamaicans, and a good Jamaican lunch keeps the ideas coming.

WHAT HACK876 IS

A one-day build competition in Kingston for about 80 secondary-school students, 5th Form through Upper 6th Form, working in teams of 3 to 4. Teams pick a real problem and finish the day with a working prototype and a pitch to judges.

When: Saturday, February 20, 2027 (tentative)

Where: Spanish Court Hotel, Kingston (confirmed)

Who: About 80 students, roughly 20 teams

Organisers: Nadani Dixon and Stefen Ewers



WHY ISLAND GRILL

Island Grill already takes its food and its team into community projects, and its founder has backed a technology scholarship at Immaculate Conception High School.

WHAT WE ARE ASKING

One lunch, in kind, for the students and adults at Hack876.

WHAT IT MAKES POSSIBLE

A proper Jamaican lunch at the midpoint of a long build day, so no student has to bring or buy food.

WHAT ISLAND GRILL RECEIVES

Food Partner recognition and a written recap.

THE NEXT STEP

A reply on whether a sponsored lunch is possible. We will then confirm the final headcount and any dietary needs in writing.

Nadani Dixon and Stefen Ewers, Hack876 organisers · info@hack876.com · Book a call: calendly.com/hack876-info/30min

01 THE REQUEST

What we are asking for, and how it would be used.

Lunch is the one moment every student shares. A one-day, in-kind Island Grill lunch is simple, concrete and close to how Island Grill already serves communities.

- ✓ **One lunch for the students and adults at the event, delivered to Spanish Court Hotel**
- ✓ **Grilled chicken, fried fish and vegetarian meals with rice and peas or festival**

QUANTITIES, TIMING AND DELIVERY

For about 80 students, plus mentors, judges, teachers and volunteers. We will give a final headcount in writing before anything is ordered.

Served at lunch, 12:00 PM, at Spanish Court Hotel in Kingston. The venue is confirmed.

The date, Saturday, February 20, 2027, is tentative until schools confirm it.

Vegetarian meals included. We will pass on any dietary needs we are told about.

WHY ISLAND GRILL

In 2024 Thalia Lyn announced the Lyn Family/Island Grill Scholarship in Technology for a deserving student at Immaculate Conception High School, her alma mater.[3]

By 2016 Island Grill's Soupaah Pot of Love had run over 180 projects and donated more than 10,000 cups of soup, including to schools across the country.[4]

In 2017 Island Grill launched its Supaah Food menu of locally grown foods, in line with the country's mandate to encourage Jamaicans to eat local and healthier.[5]

WHAT ISLAND GRILL WOULD RECEIVE

Food Partner · Inaugural Hack876

A meaningful in-kind contribution can be recognized at an equivalent level, based on a usable value agreed together. The advertised value of software credits or volunteer hours is not counted as cash automatically.

A monetary contribution is welcome instead. The levels are on the last page.

Who is running it, and what we need from you.

ORGANISERS	Nadani Dixon (Redfin) and Stefen Ewers (Georgia Tech) lead the event and are the contacts for this proposal.
VENUE	Spanish Court Hotel in Kingston is confirmed as the venue.
DATE	Saturday, February 20, 2027 is the working date. It is tentative until confirmed with schools.
JUDGES	7 judges have confirmed, from Tesla, Microsoft, Meta, Google, Accenture, Diageo, HashiCorp.

Schools: 2 confirmed, 1 in talks, 6 not yet confirmed, from a network of 9 in Kingston. Partners and donors do not receive student contact details, and there are no sign-ups or selling on the day. Photos and names are used only with school and parent consent.

Thalia Lyn is an Immaculate alumna, the first inductee of its Hall of Fame in 2013, and announced a technology scholarship there in 2024. Our judge Sheneska Williams is an Immaculate alumna too.[3] Status with Hack876: not yet confirmed.

THE DECISION WE ARE ASKING FOR

A reply on whether a sponsored lunch is possible. We will then confirm the final headcount and any dietary needs in writing.

Your contact: Nadani Dixon and Stefen Ewers, Hack876 organisers · info@hack876.com · Book a call: calendly.com/hack876-info/30min

WHAT YOU WOULD RECEIVE AFTERWARDS: A WRITTEN RECAP

- ✓ **How many students, teams and schools took part**
- ✓ **What the teams built, with the finalist projects described**
- ✓ **How your contribution was used**
- ✓ **Photos, only where schools and parents have consented**

We will document the recognition delivered and report the results we have. Audience reach and commercial outcomes are not guaranteed. Student contact details are not shared.

If a monetary contribution suits better: the levels.

Bronze Partner

J$50,000 to below J$200,000

OUR SUGGESTION

- Recognition on the Hack876 website
- Included in the grouped sponsor thank-you
- Named in the post-event recap

Silver Partner

J$200,000 to below J$500,000

- Everything in Bronze
- Placement on event signage
- Acknowledgement in the opening and closing

Gold Partner

J$500,000 to below J$1,000,000

- Everything in Silver
- More prominent placement on the website and event signage
- A dedicated sponsor feature**
- Logo on event shirts, if shirts are produced*

Platinum Partner

J$1,000,000+

- Everything in Gold
- The most prominent placement on the website and event signage

These are proposed benefits, to be agreed when a sponsorship is confirmed. A sponsor can contribute any amount within a band.

*Shirt placement applies only if event shirts are produced and artwork arrives before the production deadline.

**The form of the sponsor feature is agreed with each Gold or Platinum partner before it is confirmed.

The judging panel decides every award. Sponsorship does not buy influence over judging, and no level carries naming rights.

In-kind & Community Support: For contributions in kind, and for contributions below J$50,000. A meaningful in-kind contribution can be recognized at an equivalent level, based on a usable value agreed together. The advertised value of software credits or volunteer hours is not counted as cash automatically.

SOURCES

1. Jamaica Gleaner, "Island Grill targets 30 stores by 2030 in stepped-up expansion (September 16, 2026)." jamaica-gleaner.com/article/business/20260916/island-grill-targets-30-stores-2030-stepped-expansion

2. Island Grill, "Despite COVID-19, the NEW King Street Island Grill Will Open (About Island Grill, May 10, 2020)." www.islandgrillja.com/blog/post/despite-covid19-the-new-king-street-island-grill-will-open

3. Jamaica Observer, "Lyn announces technology scholarship at Immaculate High (March 24, 2024)." www.jamaicaobserver.com/2024/03/24/lyn-announces-technology-scholarship-immaculate-high/

4. Jamaica Gleaner, "Island Grill serving up soup to those in need (June 19, 2016)." jamaica-gleaner.com/article/news/20160624/island-grill-serving-soup-those-need

5. Island Grill, "Press: Island Grill Launches Supaah Foods (July 26, 2017)." www.islandgrillja.com/press

6. Jamaica Observer, "A taste of perseverance: The Island Grill Story (August 21, 2024)." www.jamaicaobserver.com/2024/08/21/taste-perseverance-island-grill-story/

A private partnership proposal prepared for Thalia Lyn, Founder and Deputy Chairman, Island Grill, with Tania Waldron-Gooden, Chief Executive Officer.